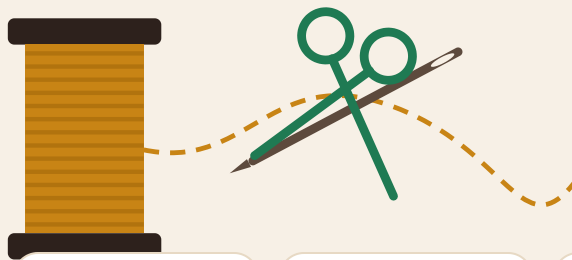


SEWING **AT** HOME

OTO 3 · REPEAT CLIENTS

The Repeat Client Engine™

The system that turns every client into three jobs: what to send after the work, when to offer the next piece, and how to get her to send her friends.



3-job follow-up system

18 ready messages

Measurement cards

Seasonal calendar

Thank-you & referral cards

Custom order form

Inside the engine

Set it up once (about 2 hours), then it runs in 10 minutes a week.

1 The 3-Job Follow-Up System

Day 1 / 14 / 45 messages for alterations clients, custom-garment clients and product buyers — text and email versions.

2 Client Measurement Cards

How to measure, when to re-measure, remote clients and the women / men / kids size charts.

3 The Seasonal Wardrobe Calendar

12 months: what clients need, what to promote, what to prep + a day-45 hook for each month.

4 Cards, Referrals & Custom Orders

How to print and use the cards, referral rules, the order form and the Client Follow-Up Log.

+ Printables (separate PDFs)

Measurement cards (women, men, kids) · thank-you & referral cards with cut lines · custom order form.

SETUP CHECKLIST (2 HOURS, ONCE)

1. Print 10 measurement cards of each type and keep them in a folder or a recipe box, A–Z.
2. Print 2 sheets of each thank-you design and 3 sheets of each referral design; cut them.
3. Print 5 custom order forms.
4. Copy the 9 text/DM messages into your phone's notes (or keyboard text shortcuts).
5. Print the Client Follow-Up Log and add every client you had in the last 60 days.
6. Mark this month and next month from the Seasonal Calendar on your wall calendar.

The 3-Job Follow-Up System

Three messages after every job — day 1, day 14 and day 45 — for alterations clients, custom-garment clients and product buyers. Each one comes as a short text/DM and as an email, ready to copy.

A new client costs you posts, messages and hours. A past client costs you one message. The system is simple: thank her while she is happy (day 1), offer the obvious next job while she still remembers you (day 14), and tie the third job to her calendar (day 45).

Day 1

Thank + lock in the fit
→ trust & reviews

Day 14

The obvious next job
→ job #2

Day 45

Her season, her event
→ job #3

The rules

- **Three messages, not thirty.** Day 1, 14 and 45 after pickup or delivery. That's it — unless she writes back.
- **Personal, never bulk.** Send them one by one from your phone or email, with her name and her garment. Bulk blasts to people who didn't ask for them feel like spam (and in the US, commercial email must include a way to opt out).
- **One clear ask per message.** Day 1 = fit and photo. Day 14 = the next job. Day 45 = the season.
- **Follow the channel she used.** Text if she texted, Messenger if she came from Facebook, Etsy messages for Etsy buyers, email only if she gave you her email.
- **Log it.** The Client Follow-Up Log (page at the end) has columns for pickup date, day 14 and day 45. Every Monday, look at the log for 10 minutes and send what's due.

WHAT ONE CLIENT IS WORTH

Alterations client, one job: \$22. The same client with the 3-job system: \$22 + a closet sweep of 3 hems (\$45–50) + one seasonal job (\$30–75) = **\$97–147 in 45 days**, plus the friends she sends. Ten clients a month on the system is the difference between chasing strangers and a booked calendar.

A. Alterations clients

Hems, take-ins, zippers, repairs. Average ticket \$20–35. The goal is to turn one hem into a closet-full of work: most women have 5–10 garments they don't wear because of fit.

Day 1 • Thank her and lock in the fit

Day 1

TEXT / DM VERSION

Hi [name]! Thank you for trusting me with your [garment] 🧡 Wear it a couple of times this week — if anything feels off (length, waist, anything), I adjust it free within 7 days. Enjoy it!

EMAIL VERSION • SUBJECT: YOUR [GARMENT] — AND A FREE ADJUSTMENT IF YOU NEED IT

Hi [name],

Thank you for bringing me your [garment]. I hope it fits exactly the way you wanted.

Wear it a couple of times this week. If anything feels off — the length with different shoes, the waist after lunch — bring it back within 7 days and I'll adjust it free.

Thank you for supporting a small, local business.
[Your first name]

Tip: Send the same day or the evening after pickup. Put the referral card in the bag at pickup.

Day 14 • Uncover the rest of her closet

Day 14

TEXT / DM VERSION

Hi [name]! How are the [pants] working out? 😊 Quick idea: most of my clients have a few more pieces sitting in the closet because of fit. If you bring 3 or more together, basic hems are \$15 each. Want me to save you a spot on [Tuesday/Saturday]?

EMAIL VERSION • SUBJECT: THE "CLOSET SWEEP" — 3 PIECES, ONE DROP-OFF

Hi [name],

I hope your [garment] is getting lots of wear!

Here's something my clients love: a closet sweep. Pull out everything you don't wear because it's too long, too loose or has a broken zipper. Bring 3 or more pieces in one drop-off and basic hems are \$15 each.

My next drop-off windows are [Tuesday 5–7 pm] and [Saturday 9–11 am]. Just reply with the day that suits you.

[Your first name]

Tip: This is the message that produces the second job. Keep it light and specific (3 pieces, a price, two times).

Day 45 • Tie the next job to her calendar

Day 45

TEXT / DM VERSION

Hi [name]! [Season/event] is coming up 🌸 If you have anything to get ready — [a dress for a wedding / summer shorts from old jeans / school uniforms] — my calendar is filling up for [month]. Want me to hold a spot? And thank you for sending [friend's name] my way!

EMAIL VERSION • SUBJECT: GETTING READY FOR [SEASON/EVENT]?

Hi [name],

[Season/event] is around the corner, and this is when my calendar fills up fastest.

If you have something to get ready — a dress for a wedding, jeans to turn into shorts, school clothes to let down — reply this week and I'll reserve a spot for you before I open the rest of the calendar.

And a reminder: every friend you send me gets \$5 off her first job, and you get \$5 off your next one.

[Your first name]

Tip: Use the Seasonal Wardrobe Calendar (Part 3) to pick the hook for the month you are in.

B. Custom-garment clients

Made-to-measure skirts, dresses, kids' outfits, special-occasion pieces. Average ticket \$60–250. She already has her measurement card on file — the second piece is easier for both of you.

Day 1 • Celebrate the piece, ask for a photo

Day 1

TEXT / DM VERSION

Hi [name]! I loved making your [dress] 🥰 I'd be so happy to see it worn — if you take a photo at [the event / out and about], send it my way (no face needed). And remember: small tweaks are free for 14 days.

EMAIL VERSION • SUBJECT: I LOVED MAKING YOUR [GARMENT]

Hi [name],

Thank you for letting me make your [garment]. I really enjoyed this one — [one specific detail: the pockets, the color, the twirl].

Two things:

- If anything needs a small tweak (length, straps), it's free for 14 days.
- If you take a photo wearing it, I'd love to see it (no face needed — and I only share it if you say yes).

Your measurements are saved on your client card, so the next piece is even easier.

[Your first name]

Tip: Save her measurements on a client card the day you finish the piece.

Day 14 • Offer the matching or the next piece

Day 14

TEXT / DM VERSION

Hi [name]! How did the [dress] go at [event]? 🧡 I still have enough [fabric] to make a [matching scrunchie / a top / a little dress for your daughter] — and since your measurements are on file, I can have it ready in [7] days. Interested?

EMAIL VERSION • SUBJECT: A LITTLE SOMETHING TO MATCH YOUR [GARMENT]

Hi [name],

I hope your [garment] got all the compliments it deserved!

I still have some of your [fabric] left. I could turn it into [a matching top / a mini-me dress for your daughter / a clutch]. Since your measurements are already on your client card, it's just [price] and ready in [7] days.

Would you like me to set it aside for you?

[Your first name]

Tip: Leftover fabric is the easiest upsell there is. Keep every piece bigger than 30 × 30 cm / 12 × 12 in, labelled with the client's name.

Day 45 • Plan her next season

Day 45

TEXT / DM VERSION

Hi [name]! I'm planning my [season] sewing calendar and wanted to give you first pick before I open it up. Is there a piece you've been dreaming of for [summer / the holidays / her birthday]? Your measurements are ready — I'd just want to re-check [waist / her height] 😊

EMAIL VERSION • SUBJECT: FIRST PICK OF MY [SEASON] CALENDAR

Hi [name],

I'm opening my [season] calendar next week and I like to give my past clients first pick.

If there's a piece you've been thinking about — a dress for [event], a pair of wide-leg linen pants, a matching set for the kids — reply with a photo of the style and I'll send a quote. I'll just re-check one or two measurements (kids grow fast!).

First-pick spots are open until [date].

[Your first name]

Tip: Kids' measurements: re-check every 3 months. Adults: every 12 months or after a noticeable weight change.

C. Product buyers

Pouches, totes, aprons, kids' dresses, napkins bought on Etsy, Marketplace or at a fair. Average ticket \$15–45. The goal: a second purchase as a gift, and a first alteration or custom job.

Day 1 • Make the unboxing personal

Day 1

TEXT / DM VERSION

Hi [name]! Your [item] is on its way / ready 📦 Thank you so much for buying handmade. Little care tip: [wash cold, lay flat / press on medium]. I hope you love it!

EMAIL VERSION • SUBJECT: YOUR [ITEM] IS ON ITS WAY 📦

Hi [name],

Thank you for your order! Your [item] is packed and on its way.

Care tip: [machine wash cold, lay flat to dry, press on medium heat]. That keeps the shape and the colors for years.

There's a little card inside the package — keep it, it's worth \$5 for you and for a friend.

[Your first name]

Tip: On Etsy, use the order message; on Marketplace, the chat. Always include the thank-you card in the package.

Day 14 • Ask for the review + open the gift door

Day 14

TEXT / DM VERSION

Hi [name]! I hope you're enjoying your [item] 😊 If you have a minute, a quick review helps my small shop so much. And if you're thinking about gifts for [teachers / birthdays / Mother's Day], I can make a set of 3 with gift wrap for \$[price].

EMAIL VERSION • SUBJECT: HOW'S YOUR [ITEM]? (+ A GIFT IDEA)

Hi [name],

It's been two weeks — I hope your [item] is already part of your routine!

If you're happy with it, a short review would mean the world to my small shop: [where to review].

And if you have gifts coming up (teachers, birthdays, bridesmaids), I make gift sets of 3 in matching prints, wrapped and ready to give, for \$[price].

[Your first name]

Tip: Etsy lets you message a buyer about her order; don't send promotions to people who never bought from you.

TEXT / DM VERSION

Hi [name]! Thanks again for your [item] order 🧡 Did you know I also do hems, repairs and custom pieces? If anything in your closet doesn't fit quite right, send me a photo and I'll give you a price in a few minutes.

EMAIL VERSION • SUBJECT: MORE THAN [POUCHES]: I ALSO FIX AND MAKE CLOTHES

Hi [name],

Thank you again for choosing handmade.

Something many buyers don't know: I also do alterations (hems, take-ins, zippers) and made-to-measure pieces — skirts, dresses, kids' outfits.

If there's anything in your closet that doesn't fit quite right, reply with a photo and I'll send you a price range right away. [Local pickup / mail-in instructions].

[Your first name]

Tip: For buyers far away, offer made-to-measure pieces by mail using the self-measuring guide (Part 2).

When she replies

SITUATION	WHAT TO SEND
She replies “yes” to the closet sweep	Wonderful! I've saved [day, time] for you. Bring everything on a hanger or in a bag, plus the shoes you wear with the pants and dresses. We'll pin them together — it takes about 15 minutes.
She says “not now”	No problem at all! I'll check in again before [next season]. Your client card is on file whenever you need me 😊
She sends a friend	Thank you so much for sending [friend]! Your \$5 is on your client card — it comes off your next job automatically 💛
She complains about the fit after day 7	I'm sorry it's not perfect! Bring it in on [day] and let's look at it together. If it's something I did, I'll fix it free; if it's a new change, I'll tell you the price before I touch it.
No reply to day 14	Do nothing. The day-45 message goes out as planned. Never send more than one extra nudge between the three messages.

THE HANDWRITTEN VERSION (DAY 1, IN THE BAG)

On the thank-you card: “[Name], thank you for trusting me with your [garment]. Wear it this week — if anything feels off, I adjust it free within 7 days. — [Your first name]”. Handwritten takes 40 seconds and is the part clients photograph and share.

Client Measurement Cards

Take her measurements once, sew for her forever. How to measure, when to re-measure, and the size charts behind every pattern in your Sewing Pattern Bible. The fill-in cards for women, men and kids are in the printables folder.

A measurement card is a business tool, not paperwork. It lets you quote a custom piece by text, start cutting before the fitting, and say “your measurements are on file” — the sentence that makes the second order easy.

KIT

- Fiberglass tape measure with cm on one side and inches on the other (vinyl tapes stretch)
- A 1/4 in / 6 mm elastic tied around the waist (marks the natural waist)
- A full-length mirror, a hard chair, a pencil

HOW TO MEASURE WELL

- Over thin clothing or the underwear she will wear with the garment
- Tape snug but not tight: one finger slides under it
- Tape level all the way round — check in the mirror
- Write cm or in on the card, never both mixed in one column

Where to measure

MEASUREMENT	HOW	FOR
Height	Barefoot, back against a wall, heels together. Mark the top of the head with a book laid flat.	Everyone
Neck	Around the base of the neck, over the Adam's apple on men; 1 finger inside the tape.	Men, women (collars)
High bust	Around the chest, under the arms, above the full bust, tape high across the back.	Women
Full bust / chest	Around the fullest part of the bust or chest, tape level across the back. She wears the bra she'll wear with the garment.	Everyone
Underbust	Directly under the bust, snug.	Women
Waist	The narrowest part of the torso, usually 1 in / 2.5 cm above the navel. Tie a piece of elastic around the waist; it rolls to the natural waist.	Everyone
High hip	About 4 in / 10 cm below the waist, over the hip bones.	Women
Full hip / seat	The fullest part of the bottom, feet together, tape level. Usually 7–9 in / 18–23 cm below the waist on adults.	Everyone
Shoulder width	From the tip of one shoulder bone to the other, across the back.	Everyone

MEASUREMENT	HOW	FOR
Back length (nape to waist)	From the bone at the base of the neck to the waist elastic, down the center back.	Everyone
Front length (shoulder to waist)	From the shoulder at the neck, over the bust point, to the waist.	Women
Arm length	From the shoulder tip, over the slightly bent elbow, to the wrist bone.	Everyone
Bicep	Around the fullest part of the upper arm, arm relaxed.	Everyone
Wrist	Around the wrist bone.	Everyone
Inseam	Inside leg, from the crotch to the floor (or to the desired hem), barefoot. Easier: measure a pair of pants that fits.	Everyone
Outseam / waist to floor	Side of the body, from the waist to the floor.	Everyone
Crotch depth (rise)	Sitting on a hard chair: side waist to the chair seat.	Everyone
Thigh	Around the fullest part of the thigh.	Everyone
Waist to knee	Side waist to the middle of the knee (skirt and dress lengths).	Women, kids

WHEN TO RE-MEASURE

- **Kids:** every 3 months, and always before a school year or a special event. Kids 2–10 grow about 6 cm / 2 1/2 in a year.
- **Adults:** every 12 months, after a weight change of about 5 lb / 2 kg or more, after pregnancy, or before any fitted formal piece.
- **Every custom piece:** re-check waist and hip at the first fitting, even if the card is recent.

MEASURING CLIENTS WHO LIVE FAR AWAY

Send her this page's "Where to measure" table and ask a friend to measure her. Ask for 3 extra things: her height, a photo from the front and side in fitted clothes, and the measurements of a garment she loves (lay it flat, measure across). Cross-check: if her hip measurement and her favorite pants' flat hip $\times$ 2 differ by more than 4 cm / 1 1/2 in, ask again before cutting.

Size charts (the same used in every Sewing Pattern Bible pattern)

Body measurements, not garment measurements. Inches rounded to the nearest 1/4 in. Choose the size by bust (tops, dresses) or hip (skirts, pants); grade between sizes at the waist.

Women • EU 34–56

EU SIZE	US LABEL	BUST CM / IN	WAIST CM / IN	HIP CM / IN
34	XS	80 / 31 1/2	62 / 24 1/2	88 / 34 3/4
36	S	84 / 33	66 / 26	92 / 36 1/4
38	M	88 / 34 3/4	70 / 27 1/2	96 / 37 3/4
40	M-L	92 / 36 1/4	74 / 29 1/4	100 / 39 1/4
42	L	96 / 37 3/4	78 / 30 3/4	104 / 41
44	XL	100 / 39 1/4	82 / 32 1/4	108 / 42 1/2
46	XL-2XL	106 / 41 3/4	88 / 34 3/4	114 / 45
48	2XL	112 / 44	94 / 37	120 / 47 1/4
50	3XL	118 / 46 1/2	100 / 39 1/4	126 / 49 1/2
52	3XL-4XL	124 / 48 3/4	106 / 41 3/4	132 / 52
54	4XL	130 / 51 1/4	112 / 44	138 / 54 1/4
56	5XL	136 / 53 1/2	118 / 46 1/2	144 / 56 3/4

Men • EU 44–56

EU SIZE	US LABEL	CHEST CM / IN	WAIST CM / IN	HIP CM / IN
44	XS	88 / 34 3/4	76 / 30	90 / 35 1/2
46	S	92 / 36 1/4	80 / 31 1/2	94 / 37
48	M	96 / 37 3/4	84 / 33	98 / 38 1/2
50	L	100 / 39 1/4	88 / 34 3/4	102 / 40 1/4
52	XL	104 / 41	92 / 36 1/4	106 / 41 3/4
54	2XL	110 / 43 1/4	98 / 38 1/2	112 / 44
56	3XL	116 / 45 3/4	104 / 41	118 / 46 1/2

Kids • sizes 2–10

SIZE	HEIGHT CM / IN	CHEST CM / IN	WAIST CM / IN	HIP CM / IN
2	92 / 36 1/4	53 / 20 3/4	51 / 20	55 / 21 3/4
3	98 / 38 1/2	55 / 21 3/4	52 / 20 1/2	57 / 22 1/2
4	104 / 41	57 / 22 1/2	53 / 20 3/4	60 / 23 1/2
5	110 / 43 1/4	59 / 23 1/4	54 / 21 1/4	62 / 24 1/2
6	116 / 45 3/4	61 / 24	55 / 21 3/4	64 / 25 1/4

SIZE	HEIGHT CM / IN	CHEST CM / IN	WAIST CM / IN	HIP CM / IN
7	122 / 48	64 / 25 1/4	57 / 22 1/2	67 / 26 1/2
8	128 / 50 1/2	66 / 26	58 / 22 3/4	70 / 27 1/2
10	140 / 55	71 / 28	61 / 24	75 / 29 1/2

PART 3

The Seasonal Wardrobe Calendar

Twelve months of what your clients need, what to promote and what to prepare — so the day-45 message always has a reason, and you are ready before prom, weddings, back-to-school and the holidays arrive.

Clients don't think about hems until they have an event. You think about their event six weeks before they do. Each month below has the demand, the offer to post, the prep to do and a ready-made hook for your day-45 message.

The big 8 seasons at a glance

SEASON	WHEN (US)	WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU
Prom (US)	Mid-March to early June	Fittings 3–6 weeks before; hem + take-in \$75–125
Weddings	May to October (peaks June & September)	Bustles 3–6 weeks before; bridesmaid hems \$45–75
Back to school	Mid-July to early September	Uniform hems and let-downs \$10–15 each; pencil pouches
Halloween	Mid-September to October 31	Custom costumes \$45–120; book by mid-September
Holidays	Mid-November to December 24	Family pajamas, party dresses, gifts; cut-off ~December 10
Mother's Day (US)	Second Sunday of May	Aprons, gift sets; sell 3–4 weeks before
Easter	March or April	Matching kids' sets; take orders 3 weeks before
Graduation	May to June	Dress hems, sash and stole hems

Year strip — when each season needs you

SEASON	JAN	FEB	MAR	APR	MAY	JUN	JUL	AUG	SEP	OCT	NOV	DEC
Prom												
Weddings												
Back to school												
Halloween												
Holidays												
Coats & zippers												
Gifts (products)												

January

MONTH 1

WHAT CLIENTS NEED

Returned holiday clothes that don't fit, New Year wardrobe clean-out, winter coats with broken zippers.

WHAT TO PROMOTE

"Closet reset" bundle: 3 hems \$50 · coat zipper replacement · repairs for favorite sweaters.

WHAT TO PREP

Order separating zippers (24–30 in / 60–76 cm) before the rush · plan Valentine's products · take stock of leftover holiday fabric.

Day-45 hook: "New year, clothes that actually fit: bring me 3 pieces you never wear."

February

MONTH 2

WHAT CLIENTS NEED

Valentine's outfits, early prom shopping (dresses bought now need altering in March–April), winter kids' growth spurt.

WHAT TO PROMOTE

Valentine's gift sets (pouch + scrunchies) · first prom booking announcement · kids' pant let-downs.

WHAT TO PREP

Open your prom calendar: block 2 evenings per week for fittings from mid-March · buy red/pink prints.

Day-45 hook: "Prom dress already bought? Book your fitting now — spring fills up fast."

March

MONTH 3

WHAT CLIENTS NEED

Prom alterations start, Easter outfits, spring wardrobe (lighter fabrics), wedding party dresses ordered.

WHAT TO PROMOTE

Prom & formal hems (#31, #33) · Easter matching kids' outfits · spring linen skirts made to measure.

WHAT TO PREP

Stock chiffon-friendly thread and microtex 60/8–70/10 needles · rolled-hem foot · pastel fabrics for Easter sets.

Day-45 hook: "Easter outfits for the whole family — matching sets ready in 10 days."

April

MONTH 4

WHAT CLIENTS NEED

Prom peak, bridesmaid dresses, Mother's Day gifts, spring cleaning of closets.

WHAT TO PROMOTE

Bridesmaid packages (hem + straps) · Mother's Day aprons and gift sets · "closet sweep" bundles.

WHAT TO PREP

Book prom fittings no later than 3 weeks before each school's date · make 6–10 aprons and pouches for Mother's Day.

Day-45 hook: "Mother's Day is coming — handmade aprons and gift sets, wrapped and ready."

May

MONTH 5

WHAT CLIENTS NEED

Weddings season begins, graduations, Mother's Day, summer shorts from old jeans.

WHAT TO PROMOTE

Graduation dress hems · jeans-to-shorts (\$18–25) · wedding guest dress take-ins · teacher gifts for end of school.

WHAT TO PREP

Bridal bustles need 3–6 weeks: confirm every June–August bride now · batch teacher-gift pouches and totes.

Day-45 hook: "Turn your old jeans into summer shorts — \$18, ready in 5 days."

June

MONTH 6

WHAT CLIENTS NEED

Weddings peak, summer vacation clothes, swim cover-ups, Father's Day.

WHAT TO PROMOTE

Wedding guest and bridesmaid alterations · linen pants and skirts made to measure · Father's Day (toiletry bags, hemmed trousers).

WHAT TO PREP

Keep 2 rush slots per week for last-minute wedding jobs (+50%) · linen and lawn in stock.

Day-45 hook: "Wedding this summer? Last fitting spots for June and July."

July

MONTH 7

WHAT CLIENTS NEED

Summer weddings, travel clothes, early back-to-school planning, US Independence Day outfits.

WHAT TO PROMOTE

Back-to-school pre-orders (kids' dresses, uniforms hems) · travel pouches · 4th of July kids' sets.

WHAT TO PREP

Announce back-to-school booking · buy navy, khaki and plaid for uniforms · elastic in bulk.

Day-45 hook: "School uniforms: book your hems now and skip the August line."

August

MONTH 8

WHAT CLIENTS NEED

Back-to-school peak: uniform hems and let-downs, kids' growth, lunch bags and pencil cases, teachers' outfits.

WHAT TO PROMOTE

Uniform let-downs (#40) · pencil pouches · named backpack tags · teacher welcome gifts.

WHAT TO PREP

Longest days of the year for alterations: pre-set a back-to-school price list · batch 20 pencil pouches.

Day-45 hook: "Growth-spurt special: let down or take up 3 kids' pants for \$36."

September

MONTH 9

WHAT CLIENTS NEED

Fall wardrobe (jackets, coats out of storage), Halloween costume ideas, fall weddings, homecoming dances.

WHAT TO PROMOTE

Coat and jacket zippers and hems · homecoming dress alterations · custom Halloween costumes (book by mid-September).

WHAT TO PREP

Costume fabrics (felt, satin, tulle) · confirm all October weddings · heavier needles 90/14–100/16.

Day-45 hook: "Custom Halloween costumes — only [8] spots this year."

October

MONTH 10

WHAT CLIENTS NEED

Halloween costumes, fall weddings, winter coats, holiday party dresses shopped early.

WHAT TO PROMOTE

Costume finishing and repairs · coat hems and linings · early holiday party dress fittings · holiday gift pre-orders.

WHAT TO PREP

Open holiday gift pre-orders (napkins, aprons, pajamas) · photograph holiday samples by mid-October.

Day-45 hook: "Holiday gifts, handmade: pre-orders open until November 15."

November

MONTH 11

WHAT CLIENTS NEED

Holiday parties, Thanksgiving (US) table linens, family photo outfits, gift season begins.

WHAT TO PROMOTE

Matching family pajamas · cloth napkins and table runners · party dress take-ins · gift sets for teachers and coworkers.

WHAT TO PREP

Last date for custom gift orders (usually December 10) — say it in every post · stock gift wrap and cards.

Day-45 hook: "Matching family pajamas for photos — order by [date]."

December

MONTH 12

WHAT CLIENTS NEED

Holiday party dresses, last-minute gifts, hemming new holiday pants, New Year's Eve outfits.

WHAT TO PROMOTE

Rush alterations (+50%) · ready-made stock (pouches, scrunchies, bandanas) · gift cards for "a hem on me".

WHAT TO PREP

Stop custom orders by the cut-off date · rest the week after Christmas · plan January's closet-reset campaign.

Day-45 hook: "No time? Give a gift card for alterations — she picks the garment."

SOUTHERN HEMISPHERE (AUSTRALIA, NEW ZEALAND)

Shift the weather-driven items by six months: coats and zippers in March–June, summer shorts and linen in October–January. School starts late January–early February and formal/"formals" season runs roughly August–November. Holidays, Easter and Mother's Day (second Sunday of May in AU/NZ) stay on their dates; UK Mother's Day falls in March.

Thank-You Cards, Referral Cards & the Custom Order Form

How to print, fill and use the printables so every job ends with a thank-you, a referral and a clear agreement.

THANK-YOU CARDS (3 DESIGNS)

- "Thank you" — general, for every client
- "Your fit, fixed." — alterations, with the 7-day free adjustment reminder
- "Made by hand, just for you" — products, with care checkboxes

Write 1–2 lines by hand on the back. Put it in the bag or the package, on top.

REFERRAL CARDS (2 DESIGNS)

- "Give this to a friend" — \$5 off her first job, \$5 off your next one
- "Made-to-measure for a friend" — \$10 off a custom piece of \$60+

Fill in her name and a code (her initials + month, e.g. **JM-04**) before you hand it over. Write the code in your Follow-Up Log so you know who sent whom.

REFERRAL PROGRAM RULES (COPY THEM INTO YOUR POLICIES NOTE)

1. The friend must be a new client and bring the card (or mention the code) at her first drop-off.
2. Both discounts apply once the friend's job is picked up and paid.
3. No limit: 4 friends = \$20 off her next job. Credits don't turn into cash.
4. Cards expire 90 days after the date written on them — a deadline makes people act.

PRINTING THE CARDS

- Letter paper or 65–110 lb / 176–300 gsm cardstock. **Print at 100% / "Actual size"** — do not "fit to page".
- Each design is a front page followed by its back page. Print double-sided, **flip on long edge**. Test with plain paper first: hold it to the light and check the cut lines line up.
- Two 6 × 4 in / 15.2 × 10.2 cm cards per sheet. Cut on the grey dashed lines with a paper trimmer or a craft knife and ruler.
- A4 printers: the cards fit inside A4 at 100% — the cut lines stay the same.

THE CUSTOM ORDER FORM

Use it for every made-to-measure piece and every job over \$60. Fill it together at the first meeting: garment, fabric, measurements (or her card number), fittings, deadline and the price breakdown. She signs, you take the 50% deposit, you both keep a photo of it. Page 2 has room for a sketch of the front and back and the terms she agrees to.

Most custom-order disputes come from three gaps — the deadline, the fabric and changes after cutting. The form closes all three in writing.

Client Follow-Up Log

Every Monday: 10 minutes, send what's due, tick the box.

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[illegible]

Every client is three jobs.

Thank her on day 1. Offer the next piece on day 14. Meet her season on day 45. Hand her a card for a friend every time.

Sew once. Get booked again.